



Some required background

Linear algebra

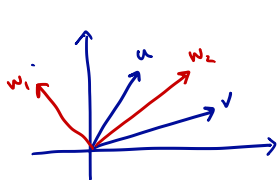
Basic multi-variable calculus

Basic understanding of algorithmic complexity

Linear Algebra Primer

Vectors in $\mathbb{R}^1, \mathbb{R}^d$ — $v \in \mathbb{R}^d : v = (v_1, \dots, v_d)$

linear (in)dependence, span, basis



$u, v \in \mathbb{R}^2$.

① $\{u, v\}$ span $\mathbb{R}^2$

$\forall w \in \mathbb{R}^2, \exists \alpha, \beta$ st.

$$w = \alpha u + \beta v$$

More generally: $\{v_1, \dots, v_k\}$ span $\mathbb{R}^k$ if $\forall w \in \mathbb{R}^k, \exists \alpha_1, \dots, \alpha_k$

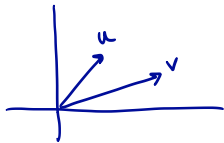
$$w = \sum \alpha_i v_i$$

$\{v_1, \dots, v_k\}$ span V if ...

Linear independence:

$v_1, \dots, v_k$ are linearly independent if there is no way to describe one of them as a linear comb. of the others.

In other words: If $\alpha_1 v_1 + \alpha_2 v_2 + \dots + \alpha_k v_k = 0$
then $\alpha_i = 0, \forall i$.



$$\begin{aligned} \text{If } \alpha_1 u + \alpha_2 v = 0 &\Rightarrow \alpha_1 u = -\alpha_2 v \\ &\Rightarrow u = \left(-\frac{\alpha_2}{\alpha_1}\right) v \end{aligned}$$

Therefore, the only way for this equation: $\alpha_1 u + \alpha_2 v = 0$ to hold, is $\alpha_1 = \alpha_2 = 0$
 $\Rightarrow u, v$ are independent.

Basis: If $v_1, \dots, v_n$ are independent & span $\mathbb{R}^n$, then they form a basis for $\mathbb{R}^n$.

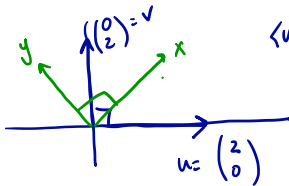
Linear Algebra Primer

$u, v \in \mathbb{R}^2$

dot / inner product : $u \cdot v = u^T v = \langle u, v \rangle = \sum_{i=1}^n u_i v_i$

outer product : $uv^T = \begin{pmatrix} 1 \\ 1 \end{pmatrix} \begin{pmatrix} -1 & -1 \end{pmatrix}$ $n \times n$ matrix

Cauchy-Schwarz : $\langle u, v \rangle \leq \|u\|_2 \cdot \|v\|_2$



$$\langle u, v \rangle = u_1 v_1 + u_2 v_2 = 0 \cdot 1 + 2 \cdot 0 = 0.$$

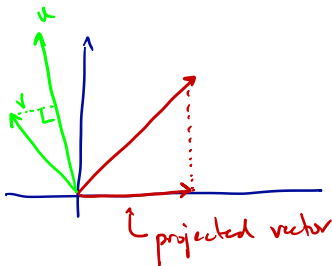
$$x = \begin{pmatrix} 1 \\ 1 \end{pmatrix}, y = \begin{pmatrix} -1 \\ 1 \end{pmatrix} \quad x^T y = -1 + 1 = 0.$$

Linear Algebra Primer

angle ~~u, v~~ u, v perp. $\iff \langle u, v \rangle = 0$

$$\cos \theta = \frac{\langle u, v \rangle}{\|u\|_2 \cdot \|v\|_2}$$

projection



Given vectors v , and u
the projection of v onto

$$u: \frac{\langle v, u \rangle}{\|u\|_2^2} \cdot u$$

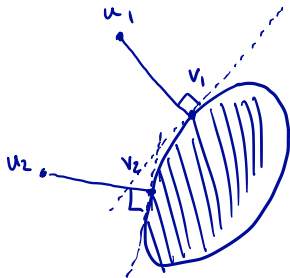
Linear Algebra Primer

projection onto a subspace

We can project onto a subspace spanned by vectors $u_1, \dots, u_k$.
If $u_1, \dots, u_k$ are perpendicular to each other, and of length 1,
then
$$\text{Proj}_{\{u_1, \dots, u_k\}}(v) = \langle v, u_1 \rangle \cdot u_1 + \langle v, u_2 \rangle \cdot u_2 + \dots + \langle v, u_k \rangle \cdot u_k$$

projection onto a convex set

$$\|u_1 - u_2\|_2 \geq \|v_1 - v_2\|_2$$



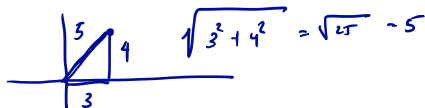
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$$x \in \mathbb{R}^d$$

L-p norms :

$\|x\|_2$ - "Euclidean Length" aka 'Euc. norm'

$$\|x\|_2 = \sqrt{\sum x_i^2}$$



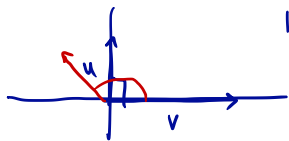
$$\langle x, x \rangle = \|x\|_2^2$$

For $1 \leq p \leq \infty$ $\|x\|_p = \left(\sum |x_i|^p \right)^{1/p}$

$\|x\|_\infty$ = largest in abs. value entry of x

triangle inequality / Pythagorean theorem

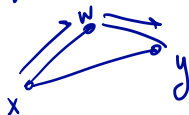
$$= \max_i |x_i|$$



$$\|u\|^2 + \|v\|^2 = \|u-v\|^2$$

If angle is $\geq 90^\circ \Rightarrow \|u\|^2 + \|v\|^2 \leq \|u-v\|^2$

Triangle Ineq;



$$\|x-y\|_2 \leq \|x-w\|_2 + \|w-y\|_2$$

Linear Algebra Primer

matrix rank, determinant, null space, range (1/2)

Matrix: $M \in \mathbb{R}^{m \times n}$

m $\begin{matrix} n \\ \boxed{M} \end{matrix}$

Null space (M): $\{x \in \mathbb{R}^n : Mx = 0\}$

Range (M): $\{y \in \mathbb{R}^m : y = Mx, \text{ for some } x \in \mathbb{R}^n\}$

Rank (M) = dimension of span of columns of M
= " " " rows of M

If M is $n \times n$, $\text{rank}(M) = n$ iff $\det M = 0$

iff $\text{null}(M) = \{0\}$

iff $\text{Range}(M) = \mathbb{R}^n$

Linear Algebra Primer

matrix rank, determinant, null space, range (2/2)

If $\det M = 0$ (M is $n \times n$)

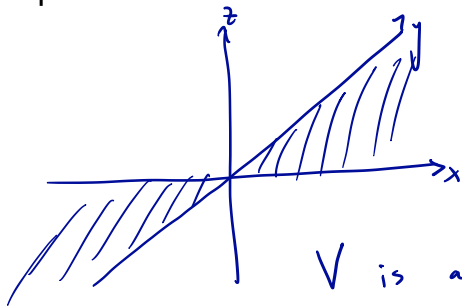
$\Rightarrow$ the columns of M cannot all be independent

also

the rows of M cannot all be independent.

Linear Algebra Primer

subspace



$\text{span}\{x, y\} \rightarrow$ a
subspace.

V is a subspace if it is
closed under addition & scaling.

Linear Algebra Primer

orthogonal complement of a subspace

For V a subspace :

$$V^\perp = \{w : \langle w, v \rangle = 0, \forall v \in V\}$$

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affine subspace

Subspace translated by a fixed vector.

Linear Algebra Primer

symmetric matrices, eigenvalues and eigenvectors (1/2)

M an $n \times n$ matrix, M is symmetric if $M = M^T$,
i.e., $M_{ij} = M_{ji}$.

(λ, v) is an eigenvalue-eigenvector pair for M if

$$Mv = \lambda v. \quad \text{Ex: } M = \begin{bmatrix} 1 & 1 \\ 1 & 1 \end{bmatrix}$$

$v = \begin{pmatrix} 1 \\ 1 \end{pmatrix}$, $\lambda = 2$ is an
eigenvector-eigenvalue pair. So is: $v = \begin{pmatrix} 1 \\ -1 \end{pmatrix}$ $\lambda = 0$

Linear Algebra Primer

symmetric matrices, eigenvalues and eigenvectors (2/2)

Fact: All eigenvectors of a symmetric matrix are perpendicular and all eigenvalues are real.

Ex: $M = \begin{pmatrix} 0 & 1 \\ -1 & 0 \end{pmatrix}$ — check that e-values are not real
(M not symmetric).

We can write: $\boxed{M = \sum \lambda_i v_i v_i^T}$ where (λ_i, v_i) is
an eigenvalue-eigenvector pair for M , and $\|v_i\|_2 = 1$.

"Eigenvalue decomposition" / "spectral decomposition"

Linear Algebra Primer

M symmetric: $M = \sum \lambda_i \underbrace{v_i v_i^T}_{\substack{\text{outer product} \\ n \times n \text{ matrix}}}$

positive semidefinite matrices (1/3)

(f M is symmetric & all $\lambda_i \geq 0$ then

M is called semidefinite

Linear Algebra Primer

positive semidefinite matrices (2/3)

A is psd iff the quadratic it defines is nonnegative $\textcircled{*}$
=

$$A \text{ is psd} \iff \underline{A = \sum \lambda_i v_i v_i^T}, \quad \lambda_i \geq 0$$
$$\iff x^T A x \geq 0 \quad \forall x \in \mathbb{R}^n$$

Let's show this: Let's write x in terms of basis $\{v_1, \dots, v_n\}$
 $\Rightarrow x = \sum \alpha_i v_i$ some α_i

$$\begin{aligned} x^T A x &= \left(\sum \alpha_i v_i \right)^T \left(\sum_j \lambda_j v_j v_j^T \right) \left(\sum_k \alpha_k v_k \right) \\ &= \left(\sum \alpha_i v_i \right)^T \cdot \sum_{j,k} \lambda_j \alpha_k \underbrace{v_j v_j^T v_k}_{=0 \text{ if } j \neq k, -1 \text{ if } j=k} = \left(\sum_i \alpha_i v_i \right)^T \sum_j \lambda_j \alpha_j \underline{v_j} \\ &= \sum_{i,j} \alpha_i \alpha_j \lambda_j \underbrace{v_i^T v_j}_{=0} = \sum_i \lambda_i \alpha_i^2. \end{aligned}$$

Linear Algebra Primer

positive semidefinite matrices (3/3)

for A any matrix, AA' and $A'A$ are always psd

Use previous fact:

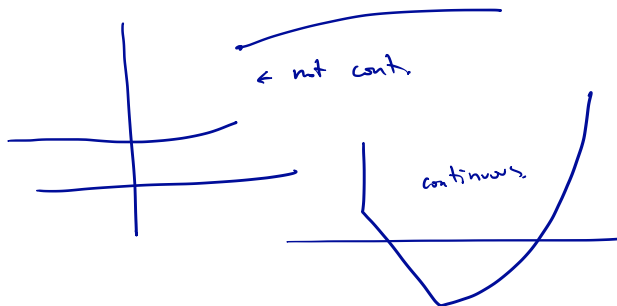
$$\rightarrow x' A A' x = \|A' x\|_2^2 \geq 0$$

" $v^T v$ "

similarly for $A'A$.

Basic Multi-variable Calculus

Continuity :



Lipschitz continuity

$f(x)$ is called is called Lipschitz continuous
if, $|f(x) - f(y)| \leq L \cdot \|x - y\|_2$

Basic Multi-variable Calculus

Gradient : $f : \mathbb{R}^n \rightarrow \mathbb{R}$

$$f(x) = f(x_1, \dots, x_n)$$

$$\nabla f(x) = \begin{pmatrix} \frac{\partial f}{\partial x_1} \\ \vdots \\ \frac{\partial f}{\partial x_n} \end{pmatrix}$$

Hessian :

$$\nabla^2 f(x) = \begin{pmatrix} \frac{\partial^2 f}{\partial x_i \partial x_j} \end{pmatrix}$$

Basic Multi-variable Calculus

Gradient/Hessian of a quadratic

$$f(x) = x^T Q x + g^T x + c$$

$$\nabla f(x) = 2 Q x + g$$

$$\nabla^2 f(x) = 2 Q$$



We will need other concepts...

...but we will develop them as needed, or provide some references...

In the meantime, some recommended references:

Introduction to Applied Linear Algebra, by Stephen Boyd and Lieven Vandenberghe
Convex Optimization, by Stephen Boyd and Lieven Vandenberghe
Linear Algebra Done Right, by Sheldon Axler